

SERVING PLAN 3 SERVING PLAN

Carne Asada Tacos

with Pico de Gallo, Avocado, and Lime Crema

Whenever we go out to a Mexican restaurant, we always order at least one *carne asada* taco—but they're actually surprisingly easy to make at home. In this Encore Recipe, we're marinating steaks in lime juice, which adds tangy acidity and helps tenderize the meat. They're grilled to prime smokiness, then tucked into warm tortillas with lime crema, crunchy cabbage, and spicy pico de gallo.

35–45 minutes 680 calories per serving

Plated.

Ingredients

- 2 limes, divided
- 2 cloves garlic
- 1 spice mix
  - ¼ teaspoon chili powder
  - ¼ teaspoon chipotle powder
  - ¼ teaspoon ground cumin
  - ⅛ teaspoon dried oregano
  - ⅛ teaspoon smoked paprika
- 3 steaks
- 2 tomatoes
- ⅛ ounce cilantro, divided
- 1 red onion
- 1 jalapeño
- ¾ cup shredded green cabbage
- 2 packets nonfat sour cream
- 9 flour tortillas
- 1 avocado

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
large resealable plastic bag (optional)
grill or grill pan (optional)
aluminum foil

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

No grill or grill pan? Use a large pan over medium-high heat instead. Toast tortillas first, then sear steaks in 1 tablespoon olive oil, 4–6 minutes per side.

USDA recommends cooking beef to 145°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Marinate steaks

Preheat grill to medium-high heat (see recipe tip). Halve **limes**. Using the flat side of a knife, gently crush **garlic cloves**. In a large shallow bowl or resealable plastic bag, stir together **spice mix**, **juice of ½ lime**, **1½ tablespoons olive oil**, **¾ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** to combine. Add **crushed garlic cloves**. Pat **steaks** dry with paper towel, add to marinade, and turn to coat. Set aside to marinate at room temperature until Step 5.



2. Prepare ingredients

Rinse remaining produce. Cut **tomatoes** into ½-inch pieces and place in a medium bowl. Roughly chop **cilantro** leaves, discarding stems. Peel **onion** and cut into small dice to yield 3 tablespoons, then add to bowl with tomatoes. Halve **jalapeño** lengthwise and, using a knife tip, discard seeds and stem. Finely chop **up to half of jalapeño** (wash your knife, board, and hands after). Save remaining onion and jalapeño for another use.



3. Make pico de gallo

Add **chopped jalapeño** (skip or use half for less heat), **juice of 1 lime**, **¼ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired to bowl with tomatoes and onion. Add **half of cilantro**, reserving remainder for serving. Toss to combine, then set aside until ready to serve. Place **cabbage** on cutting board, sprinkle over **⅛ teaspoon salt** and, using your hands, massage to soften, about 30 seconds (this is a great task for a kitchen helper).



4. Make lime crema and warm tortillas

If using a grill pan, place it over medium-high heat now. In a small bowl, stir together **sour cream** and **juice of remaining lime**. Taste and add **salt** and **pepper** as desired. Set **lime crema** aside. When grill is just smoking, arrange **tortillas** in a single layer and toast until warmed through, 30 seconds per side. Stack **tortillas** and wrap in foil to keep warm.



5. Grill steaks and prepare avocado

Remove **steaks** from marinade, allowing excess to drip off; discard **marinade** and **crushed garlic cloves**. When grill is just smoking, add **steaks** and cook until charred and medium rare, 3–4 minutes per side. Transfer to a plate and set aside to rest for about 5 minutes. Meanwhile, halve **avocado**, discarding pit. Using a spoon, carefully scoop out flesh, discarding skin, then thinly slice.



6. Plate carne asada tacos

Once **steaks** have rested, find the direction of the grain (muscle fibers) and slice across it, rather than parallel, as thinly as possible—this ensures tenderness. Divide **tortillas** among serving plates and layer with **cabbage**, **steak**, **pico de gallo**, **avocado**, and **lime crema**. Garnish **carne asada tacos** with **remaining cilantro**, and dig in!

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